

Verdant Peak Technologies - Leave Policy

Verdant Peak Technologies — Leave Policy

1. Purpose and Scope

This Leave Policy outlines the types of leave available to Verdant Peak Technologies (VPT) employees, the accrual and approval process, and the responsibilities of employees and managers in managing time away from work. It applies to all Regular Full-Time and Regular Part-Time employees; contractors and interns are governed by the terms of their individual engagement agreements. Leave balances, requests, and approvals are managed centrally through the VPT Time-Off Portal (accessible via the Employee Self-Service system).

2. Annual (Vacation) Leave

Regular Full-Time employees accrue 20 days of Annual Leave per calendar year, credited at a rate of 1.67 days per completed month of service. Employees at Senior Manager grade and above accrue 25 days per year. Part-Time employees accrue leave on a prorated basis according to their contracted hours. Annual Leave requests must be submitted through the Time-Off Portal at least 5 working days in advance for requests of 3 days or fewer, and 15 working days in advance for requests exceeding 3 consecutive days. Managers must respond to requests within 3 working days. A maximum of 10 unused Annual Leave days may be carried forward into the next calendar year; any balance beyond this is forfeited on December 31, except where local law requires otherwise.

3. Sick Leave

Employees are entitled to 12 days of paid Sick Leave per calendar year. For absences of one or two days, employees should notify their manager as early as possible on the day of absence, ideally before the start of the workday, and no formal documentation is required. For sick leave exceeding two consecutive working days, a medical certificate from a registered practitioner must be submitted to HR within 3 working days of returning to work. Unused Sick Leave does not carry forward to the next year and is not encashed upon resignation or termination. Employees who exhaust their Sick Leave balance may apply to draw from the Annual Leave balance or take unpaid leave, subject to manager approval.

4. Casual Leave

In addition to Annual and Sick Leave, employees receive 6 days of Casual Leave per year, intended for short-notice personal matters. Casual Leave may be taken in half-day increments and requires at least 1 working day of notice where feasible. Casual Leave cannot be combined with Annual Leave to create a leave block exceeding 5 consecutive working days without additional manager and HR approval.

5. Parental Leave

Maternity Leave: Employees who are pregnant are entitled to 26 weeks of paid Maternity Leave, which may begin up to 8 weeks before the expected delivery date. A medical certificate confirming the expected delivery date must be submitted to HR at least 30 days before the leave begins. **Paternity Leave:** Employees become entitled to 2 weeks of paid Paternity Leave, to be taken within 3 months of the child's birth or adoption. **Adoption Leave:** Employees who legally adopt a child under the age of 12 are entitled to 12 weeks of paid Adoption Leave. All parental leave requests should be submitted to HR at least 45 days in advance where possible, and employees are guaranteed reinstatement to the same or an equivalent role upon return.

6. Bereavement Leave

Employees may take up to 5 paid working days of Bereavement Leave upon the death of an immediate family member (spouse, child, parent, or sibling), and up to 2 paid working days for the death of an extended family member (grandparent, aunt, uncle, or in-law). Bereavement Leave may be taken non-consecutively within 30 days of the event with manager approval.

7. Marriage Leave

Employees are entitled to 5 paid working days of Marriage Leave, available once during their employment at VPT, to be taken within 30 days of the wedding date and requested at least 10 working days in advance.

8. Public Holidays

VPT observes a minimum of 10 paid public holidays per calendar year, determined annually based on the statutory holiday calendar of each employee's work location and published on the HR portal by December 1 of the preceding year. Employees required to work on a designated public holiday due to business necessity will receive a compensatory day off within 30 days or holiday pay at 2x the standard daily rate, per local law and manager discretion.

9. Leave Without Pay (LWP)

Employees who have exhausted all applicable paid leave categories may request Leave Without Pay for a maximum of 30 consecutive calendar days per year, subject to written approval from their manager, HR Business Partner, and department head. Extended LWP

beyond 30 days requires Vice President-level approval and may affect benefits continuity, including health insurance coverage, which must be separately confirmed with the Benefits team.

10. Sabbatical Leave

Employees with 5 or more years of continuous service at VPT are eligible to apply for a Sabbatical Leave of up to 8 weeks, unpaid, once every 5 years, for purposes such as further education, family care, or personal development. Applications must be submitted at least 90 days in advance and require approval from the employee's manager, HR, and the relevant Vice President.

11. Emergency and Compassionate Leave

In situations of genuine emergency (natural disaster, sudden hospitalization of a dependent, etc.), employees may take up to 3 days of paid Emergency Leave without the standard advance notice, provided they inform their manager as soon as reasonably possible and submit a brief written explanation to HR within 5 working days.

12. General Provisions

All leave requests and approvals must be recorded in the Time-Off Portal; leave taken without prior approval may be treated as unauthorized absence under the Employee Policies disciplinary procedure. Leave balances reset each calendar year on January 1, except where carry-forward provisions apply. Employees returning from any leave exceeding 4 consecutive weeks should notify HR at least 5 working days before their return date to facilitate a smooth transition back to work. Managers are responsible for ensuring adequate team coverage and should not unreasonably deny statutory leave entitlements. This policy is reviewed annually and may be adjusted to remain compliant with local labor law in each VPT operating location.